Mohammad Kassem

Beirut, Lebanon

Information Security Associate | Web App Penetration Tester

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SUMMARY

Penetration Tester and Information Security Associate with a focus on web application security and vulnerability assessment. Passionate about identifying security weaknesses, performing penetration testing, and improving application security through practical ethical hacking methodologies. Continuously developing expertise in offensive security, reconnaissance, and secure systems assessment while contributing to stronger and more resilient applications.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Offensive Application Security, Web Application Penetration Testing, API Security Testing, Vulnerability Assessment & Management, Vulnerability Research, OWASP Top 10, Authentication & Access Control Testing, Network Security Testing, Security Misconfiguration Analysis, Exploitation & Validation, Secure Coding Practices, Risk Analysis & Remediation, Security Testing Methodologies, Technical Documentation & Reporting.

EDUCATION

Lebanese University (LU), Faculty of Sciences *Beirut, Lebanon*

- Master's Degree (M2) in Cyber Security — Present

Lebanese University (LU), Faculty of Sciences *Nabatieh, Lebanon*

- Master's Degree (M1) in Computer Science — June 2025
- Bachelor of Science (BS) in Computer Science — June 2024

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder, Penetration Tester & Full Stack Web Developer *August 2025 – Present*

ShiftCode Beirut, Lebanon

- Developed, deployed and tested 4+ secure full-stack web applications from design to production.
- Identified and remediated API security flaws and access control vulnerabilities across systems.
- Managed client communication, project planning, and technical delivery ensuring timelines.

IT Specialist & Computer Instructor *September 2024 – Present*

Mohammad Saad High School Tyre, Lebanon

- Managed and maintained 20+ computers and internal IT systems across departments and users.
- Provided technical support for hardware, software, and network-related issues for end users.

Full-stack Web Development Intern *July 2024 – February 2025*

Two of Us (Techlarious) Beirut, Lebanon

- Developed responsive MERN stack web applications and APIs for scalable production use.
- Contributed to 2 full-scale projects and 3+ development tasks within agile team environments.
- Worked on authentication systems and database integration using secure best practices.

BUG BOUNTY & SECURITY RESEARCH

- Detected an **Insecure Direct Object Reference (IDOR)** bug in Kiwi.com's support chat, showing live conversation stream. **(Link)**
- Identified **missing origin validation** in postMessage handlers on Twilio's blog, enabling potential cross-origin analytics event injection. **(Link)**
- Discovered **Broken Object-Level Authorization (BOLA)** vulnerability in Kiwi.com's prebooking systems, allowing potential cross-account access to user data. **(Link)**

PROJECTS

ShiftCode – MERN Stack Web Platform (Link)
Developed a scalable MERN stack web platform with responsive interfaces, RESTful APIs, authentication systems, and database integration for dynamic content management.

Skincare by Zahraa – MERN Stack Business Website (Link)
Built a responsive MERN stack business website with secure backend APIs and database-driven product and content management features.

Bostondinio Coach – Search Engine Optimization(Link)
Led a full SEO audit and technical implementation (schema markup, local SEO, redirects, accessibility fixes) alongside Google Ads campaign setup with conversion tracking (GA4, Search Console, call and lead-form tracking) for a Boston-area transportation company.

Dedham Airport Taxi & Livery – Business Website Development & SEO Optimization (Link)
Developed a responsive, multi-page React.js website with reusable components, service pages, and interactive maps. Implemented technical and on-page SEO to improve performance, user experience, and local search visibility.

TRAINING AND CERTIFICATE

Offensive Application Security Associate | Semicolon Academy *August 2026*

- Completed 30+ hours of intensive, hands-on training in offensive application security, covering application security testing, vulnerability research, web security concepts, and offensive security methodologies.
- Developed practical skills in identifying, analyzing, and reporting web application vulnerabilities through structured security assessments aligned with professional penetration-testing practices.

Information Security Associate | Semicolon Academy *May 2026*

- Completed an intensive 9-week Ethical Hacking and Penetration Testing program focused on web application security, vulnerability assessment, API security, and cybersecurity fundamentals.
- Successfully solved 50+ hands-on labs and conducted penetration testing assessments on 2 web applications, identifying vulnerabilities such as XSS, SQL Injection, CSRF, IDOR, and Broken Access Control using Kali Linux and Burp Suite.

Ethical Hacking Foundation | Semicolon Academy *May 2025*

- Completed the Ethical Hacking (ETH) course covering penetration testing fundamentals, web vulnerabilities, Wi-Fi attacks, reconnaissance, and bug bounty hunting methodologies.

Mystery Course Program | Techlarious *February 2025*

- The program covered MERN stack development, core Cloud Computing concepts, foundational DevOps practices, and best practices in Quality Assurance for software development.

SKILLS

Cybersecurity & Penetration Testing: Penetration Testing, Vulnerability Assessment, Web Application Security, API Security Testing, OWASP Top 10, Ethical Hacking, Authentication & Access Control Testing, Secure Coding, Network Security.

Security Tools & Technologies: Kali Linux, Burp Suite, Nmap, Wireshark, Metasploit Framework, OWASP ZAP, SQLmap, Gobuster, ffuf, Nikto, Hydra, Postman, Netcat, Linux, Git, GitHub.

Integration & Development: Full-Stack Web Development, MERN Stack Development, RESTful APIs, Database Integration, React.js, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, SQL, Search Engine Optimization(SEO), Git, GitHub.

IT & Systems: IT Systems Management, System Administration, Networking, Troubleshooting.

Soft Skills: Problem-Solving, Analytical Thinking, Critical Thinking, Attention to Detail, Communication, Team Collaboration, Client Communication, Time Management, Organization, Adaptability, Initiative.

LANGUAGES

Arabic (native), **English** (advanced).